> people and compete successfully with the ascendant Hindus. Sir Syed founded what he intended to be 'the Muslim Cambridge', the Mohammadan Anglo Oriental College, at Aligarh- another of key Muslim institutions now left behind in India.

In Bengal, Dadu Mian and Titumir launched the peasant struggle known as 'Faraizi Movement'. The most religiously motivated movements were 'Deobandi' (1867) and 'Barelvi' (1883) schools of thought, which emerged for reviving the Islamic spirit in the defeated and dejected Muslims and are still the most popular sects of Indian and Pakistani Muslims.

The comments of Lewis (2002) reinforce the theory of Muslims clinging to Islam for all struggles:

> Other Muslims in other parts of the world have their own local grievances, wherever the forces of Islam and unbelief meet and clash. Sometimes other issues, including ethnic, territorial, social and economic are involved, but religion is always a major, often the major element in defining the struggle. The best-known examples, going round the frontiers of Islam, are Bosnia and Kosovo, Chechnya, Kashmir, Sinkiang, the southern Philippines, Timor, Palestine, Sudan, and a number of places in West Africa.

Therefore, the history of Indian Muslims showed that howsoever moderate they were, they clung to their faith whenever they were pushed to the wall. In struggle and resistance, they gained strength from their religious beliefs. The religious scholars and leaders led the resistance movements. However, the fact remains that the followers of religious extremists were always in minority.

Interestingly, a large majority of Muslims of India, despite being religious, never approved theocracy or *mullahcracy*. The confidence reposed in a modern leader like Muhammad Ali Jinnah rather than religious leaders spoke volumes of the mindset of the Muslims of India who strived for an independent homeland. Their aim was to eliminate Hindu hegemony that could hamper the growth and freedom of the Muslims of India. Although religious zeal was prominent during these testing times, the Muslims did not follow any Mullah or religious leader for this purpose. To date, religious parties have failed to woo a decent majority in their favour. In Pakistan, except for the stage-managed